

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

‘We can do better for our seniors’

Tribune investigation into hospitals’ use of guardianship system inspires new bill

By Christy Gutowski and Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

A Tribune investigation into some Chicago-area hospitals’ questionable use of the state’s guardianship system has resurrected legislation that would exclude private entities from being appointed as guardians in such cases.

The newspaper reported in November that if a patient in need of guardianship had property or other assets, hospitals and their lawyers usually asked the court to appoint a certain private care management organization as guardian. That organization often charges more for its services than county public guardians, which along with fees billed by lawyers working on the cases can quickly

drain a person’s savings, the Tribune found.

The bill, filed last week, would require the appointment of a state or county public guardian, if one is available, when hospitals, nursing homes or similar institutions file guardianship petitions in court.

State Rep. Marti Deuter, an Elmhurst Democrat in the second year of her first term, said she is working with AARP Illinois on the legislation. The Tribune’s two-part series underscores the need for reforms, she said.

“As I was reading the articles,

it was clear to me that we can do better for our seniors,” Deuter told the Tribune. “My interest as a policymaker is really to make sure government works as well as it can for people, and affordability is a big issue. As your articles pointed out, this is draining (people’s) resources very quickly in some cases.”

Earlier versions of the bill failed to pass in 2024 and 2025 when introduced under former state Rep. Terra Costa Howard, who left the legislature last year when she became a judge. The earlier

measure faced heavy opposition, including from the Illinois Health and Hospital Association, whose concerns included the possibility that the change could cause some patients to remain hospitalized beyond medical necessity.

Though advancing a hotly debated measure will likely be an uphill battle during an election year, Deuter said she hopes to work with all stakeholders on the issue and put forward “the best legislation we can.”

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Lisa Fleischmann sorts merchandise in her Trump Truth Store and Hangout on Tuesday in Crystal Lake. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

FAR WEST WING IN CRYSTAL LAKE

Trump Truth Store to reopen in the suburb after summer shutdown amid eviction threat

By Angie Leventis Lourgos
Chicago Tribune

A taste of Mar-a-Lago is coming to northwest suburban Crystal Lake.

After closing under threat of eviction six months ago, the controversial Trump Truth Store is reopening in a new location — a larger venue, which will offer even more MAGA-themed merchandise as well as recreational and social activities designed to bring together like-minded Trumpites.

The new Trump Truth Store is scheduled to open at 829 S. Virginia Road in Crystal Lake on

Saturday.

The shop is just over 3,100 square feet, roughly three times the size of its previous location in northwest suburban Huntley, where the business was accused of multiple municipal sign and building code ordinance violations — in part over a life-size Trump inflatable that waved outside the store along Illinois Route 47.

Business owner Lisa Fleischmann shut down the brick-and-mortar store and vacated the premises in mid-July as part of a settlement with her landlord Ricky Lynfield Inc., which had threatened the business with

eviction after several citations because of alleged code violations.

The landlord said those infractions violated the terms of the lease and demanded the store either comply with local ordinances or leave.

But Fleischmann said she’s elated for her retail revival in the new location — which will be bigger, better and stronger than the previous venue.

“It’s really big,” she added. “I definitely get my steps in every day.”

Crystal Lake officials said they were aware of the store’s relocation to their suburb, adding that

the business must abide by all city ordinances.

“The city has sign permit rules and regulations that will apply to the business, just like any other retail establishment,” said Kathryn Cowlin, Crystal Lake’s director of community development. “The business has been made aware of the rules and regulations, and the city will expect the business to abide by those regulations.”

Fleischmann said she had intended to leave the Huntley store even before the eviction proceedings began, primarily

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GOP blocks war powers measure in Senate

Two Republican senators who joined Democrats in prior vote back president

By Stephen Groves
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — Senate Republicans voted to dismiss a war powers resolution Wednesday that would have limited President Donald Trump’s ability to conduct further attacks on Venezuela after two GOP senators reversed course on supporting the legislation.

Trump put intense pressure on five Republican senators who joined with Democrats to advance the resolution last week and ultimately prevailed in heading off passage of the legislation. Two of the Republicans — Sens. Josh Hawley of Missouri and Todd Young of Indiana — flipped under the pressure.

Vice President JD Vance had to break the 50-50 deadlock in the Senate on a Republican motion to dismiss the bill.

The outcome of the high-profile vote demonstrated how Trump still has command over much of the Republican conference, yet the razor-thin vote tally also showed the growing concern on Capitol Hill over the president’s aggressive foreign policy ambitions.

Democrats forced the debate after U.S. troops captured Venezuelan leader Nicolás Maduro in a surprise nighttime raid earlier this month.

“Here we have one of the most successful attacks ever and they find a way to be against it. It’s pretty amazing. And it’s a shame,” Trump said during a speech Tuesday in Michigan. He also hurled insults at several of the Republicans who advanced the legislation, calling Sen. Rand Paul of Kentucky a “stone cold loser” and Sens. Lisa Murkowski of Alaska and Susan Collins of Maine “disasters.”

Trump’s latest comments followed earlier phone calls with the senators, which they described as terse. The president’s fury underscored how the war powers vote has taken on new political

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INSIDE



ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/TRIBUNE

Are ‘tough times’ in past for Bears CB?

Bears cornerback Kyler Gordon made a timely return against the Packers after battling injuries for most of the year. **Chicago Sports**

GREENLAND TALKS: A top Danish official said a “fundamental disagreement” remains with President Trump. **Nation & World**

Trump administration looks to settle Guard lawsuit

After Supreme Court defeat, US doesn’t want trial over deployment

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Three months ago, hundreds of federalized National Guard troops were assembling at military bases in Illinois for imminent deployment by orders of President Donald Trump to bolster his administration’s aggressive deportation campaign in the Chicago area.

The state of Illinois filed suit, leading to a daylong, emotionally charged hearing that ended with a federal judge issuing a historic restraining order blocking the

deployment.

But the atmosphere was far different in that same courtroom on Wednesday as lawyers for the Department of Justice, after a stinging defeat at the U.S. Supreme Court, said they’re now looking to settle the litigation over the controversial troop deployment short of a trial.

The development came during a status hearing before U.S. District Judge April Perry on the next steps in the lawsuit brought by Illinois, which had been headed toward a lengthy preliminary injunction hearing over the legality of Trump’s mobilization of the Guard.

But the Department of Justice’s

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Members of the Texas National Guard arrive Oct. 7, 2025, at the Army Reserve Training Center in Elwood. BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

